

O years! and age! farewell

Neil Thornock

O years! and age! farewell

This is a C score

Instrumentation

2 Flutes
2 Oboes
2 Clarinets in B $\flat$
2 Bassoons

2 Horns in F
2 Trumpets in C
2 Trombones

Percussion 1

1 Crotale (F $\sharp^2$, sounding 2 octaves higher than written)
3 Timpani (32", 29", 26")

Percussion 2

Marimba
Vibraphone
Chimes (sounding as written)
Glockenspiel (sounding 2 octaves higher than written)
1 Crotale (C 2 , sounding 2 octaves higher than written)

Harp

Chorus SATB, at least six voices per part

Violin 1
Violin 2
Viola
Cello
Bass

Duration: ca. 12 minutes

Eternity

by Robert Herrick

O years! and age! farewell:
Behold I go,
Where I do know
Infinity to dwell.

And these mine eyes shall see
All times, how they
Are lost i' th' sea
Of vast eternity:--

Where never moon shall sway
The stars; but she,
And night, shall be
Drown'd in one endless day.

Program note

In setting the text of Robert Herrick's poem *Eternity*, I was initially aware of several musical approaches that could appropriately be taken. The poem appears full of dichotomy, putting eternity in relief against time. Most simply, the poet describes time as being diametrically opposed to eternity. On a deeper level, the intent of the traveler's going somewhere is his arrival at a point where *going* can no longer be done. Thus, the goal and the action required to accomplish that goal represent the opposition of time and eternity. Activity is always associated with time ("mine eyes shall *see*," "moon shall *sway*"), while passivity represents eternity ("how they are lost," "shall be drown'd"). This dichotomy invited a musical response that was neither entirely progressive nor completely static.

More is at work in the poem, however – specifically, the poet/protagonist has not yet reached his goal, let alone departed on his journey. He is simply saying farewell at the outset, describing for our benefit (we are his audience) the glories that lie ahead. None of this is reality *yet*, although its eventuality is certain. Once the traveler has departed, our existential experience remains unchanged, except for the noticeable absence of the poet. In bidding years and age farewell, the poet is drawing a distinction between our immediate future and his: while he progresses to the unknown eternities, we must remain under the effect of time, wherein moon still sways the stars and night always follows day. From our point of view, then, we are the ones bidding farewell to the departing poet. And in the end, time still binds us, no matter how we try to conjure images of the poet's eternity.

My musical setting is an attempt to portray this interpretation of the text. The most significant musical ramification is that "endless day" is never actually reached, merely imagined, almost while we look upon the poet departing into the invisible realms. The ending leaves us in a transfixed state, wondering what such an existence could possibly entail (this is, in fact, the reality of the listener's experience, blurring the distinction between musical exegesis and concurrent psychological experience). I attempted to give equal musical weight to contrasting images: the sea, always a body of motion and commotion, and infinity, an existence of incredible, slow, transcendent unchangingness. I also imagine a tinge of forlorn longing, both for the poet who is leaving us, and for the infinitely better state in which he will soon find himself.

1

11

16

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

<

21

26

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

21

26

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

21

26

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

21

26

Vn. 1 tutti

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

31

Fl. 1 *mp* *pp* *pp* *mf*

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1 *pp*

Cl. 2

Bn. 1 *pp* *p* *pp*

Bn. 2

31

Hn. 1

Hn. 2 *pp* *mp* *pp*

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

31

Perc. 1 *pp* *rimba*

Perc. 2

Hp.

S *tenderly* *pp* *mp* *pp* *mp*

A *tenderly* *pp* *mp* *pp* *mp*

T

B

O years! and age!

31

Vn. 1 *tutti* *ppp*

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B. *ppp*

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

pp

pp

pp

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

vibraphone (motor off)
hard yarn

p

pp

p

pp

S

A

T

B

mp

pp

mp

pp

pp

p

pp

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

ppp

pp

pp

ppp

51

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

51

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

51

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

51

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

ppp

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

ppp

ppp

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

mp

Perc. 1

(chimes)

Perc. 2

(♩)

Hp.

S

A

T

B

p *mf* *p* *mf*

and age! fare - - - well: Be - hold I

and age! fare - - - well: Be - hold I

(8^{va})-----,

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

6166

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

6166

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

6166

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

6166

S

A

T

B

go, Where I do know In - - - fin - - - - i - - - - ty to

go, Where I do know In - - - fin - - - - - i - - - - - ty to

6166

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

71

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

expressively

pp

mp

p

mp

mf

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

pp

71

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

pp

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

pp

Tb. 2

71

Perc. 1

(chimes)

Perc. 2

(Xco)

Hp.

S

p

pp

A

- - i - - - ty

p

dwel.

p

B

dwel.

71

tutti

Vn. 1

gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

p

Vc.

p

D.B.

[illegible]

Fl. 1
 Fl. 2
 Ob. 1
 Ob. 2
 Cl. 1
 Cl. 2
 Bn. 1
 Bn. 2
 Hn. 1
 Hn. 2
 Tp. 1
 Tp. 2
 Tbn. 1
 Tbn. 2
 Perc. 1
 Perc. 2
 Hp.
 S.
 A.
 T.
 B.
 Vn. 1
 Vn. 2
 Va.
 Vc.
 D.B.

Musical score for a symphony orchestra and vocal ensemble. The score is divided into four systems, each containing multiple staves for different instruments and vocal parts. The key signature is one flat (B-flat), and the time signature is 3/4. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, dynamics (e.g., *pp*, *p*, *mf*, *mp*, *ppp*), articulation marks (e.g., *cup mute*), and performance instructions (e.g., *tutti*). The vocal parts (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass) have lyrics in English. The percussion parts include chimes and a xylophone. The string parts (Violins, Violas, Cellos, Double Basses) provide a harmonic foundation.

13

84

Fl. 1

f

Fl. 2

f

Ob. 1

f

Ob. 2

f

Cl. 1

f

Cl. 2

f

Bn. 1

f

Bn. 2

f

pp

84

Hn. 1

f

Hn. 2

f

Tp. 1

f

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

f

Tb. 2

pp

84

Perc. 1

timpani

Perc. 2

mf

Hp.

S

f

dwel. _____ In - - - - fin - - - i - - - - ty _____ *p*

A

f

dwel. _____ In - fin - - - i - - - - ty _____ *p*

T

f

dwel. _____ In - - - - fin - - - - i - - - - ty _____ *mp* *mf*

B

f

i - - - - ty _____ In - - - - - fin - - - - - i - - - - - ty _____

84

Vn. 1

tutti

f

Vn. 2

f

Va.

f

Vc.

f

D.B.

f

mp *p* *mf*

91

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

91

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

91

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

91

Vn. 1
tutti

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

This image shows a page from a musical score for 'The Swan' from 'The Nutcracker'. The score is for measures 1 through 5. The instruments listed on the left are Fl. 1, Fl. 2, Ob. 1, Ob. 2, Cl. 1, Cl. 2, Bn. 1, and Bn. 2. The key signature is one sharp (F#), and the time signature is 3/4. The music is written in treble and bass staves. The first four measures are mostly rests for the woodwinds, with some activity in the flutes and oboes. The fifth measure features a triplet of eighth notes in the bassoon 2 part, marked with a '3' and a 'ppp' (pianissimo) dynamic marking.

A blank musical score for six brass instruments: Horn 1, Horn 2, Trumpet 1, Trumpet 2, Trombone 1, and Trombone 2. Each instrument has a staff with a clef and a key signature of one flat. The staves are empty except for a single bar line at the beginning of each measure.

[illegible]

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

sweet, tender

mp

mf

mp

pp

p

p

p

p

pp

ppp

sounding pitch

p

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

ppp

mf

pp

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

pp

pp

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

mf

p

mp

pp

eyes

mine

eyes

shall

see

mine

eyes

shall

eyes

mine

eyes

mine

eyes

mine

eyes

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

mp

mf > p

f

p

mp

p

p

pp

p

pp

p

pp

106

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

106

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

106

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

106

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

19

111

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

111

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

111

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

mp

f

S

eyes

shall

see

all

times

A

mine

eyes

shall

see

all

T

8

these

mine

eyes

B

mine

eyes

mp

p

f

mp

111

S. Vn.

Vn. 1

gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

ppp

mf

p

pp

mp

p

pp

sounding pitch

116

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

ppp

mp > p

p

p < mp

pp

116

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

pp

pp

116

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

p

mf

p

p

mf

p

times,

shall

see

all

times,

p

mp

shall

see

all

times,

116

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

p

pp

mp

p

pp

pp

mp

p

pp

mp

pp

poco a poco accel.-----

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

poco a poco accel.-----

Perc. 1

(vibraphone)

Perc. 2

(C_{200})

Hp.

S

A

T

B

these mine eyes shall see all

these mine eyes shall see all

these mine eyes shall see all

mine eyes shall see all

poco a poco accel.-----

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

dramatico

mf *mp* *mf* *f*

pp *mf* *mp* *f*

120

♩ = 69 Faster, surging with motion

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

mp

mf

p

mp

mp

f

mf

mp

mf

mp

120

120

♩ = 69 Faster, surging with motion

[illegible]

120

♩ = 69 Faster, surging with motion

[illegible]

♩ = 84 Massive, grandiose

This musical score page contains measures 129, 130, and 131. The instruments and their parts are as follows:

- Flutes 1 & 2 (Fl. 1, Fl. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre* and play sustained notes with long horizontal lines indicating they are held throughout the measures.
- Oboes 1 & 2 (Ob. 1, Ob. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre* and play sustained notes.
- Clarinets 1 & 2 (Cl. 1, Cl. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre* and play sustained notes.
- Bassoons 1 & 2 (Bn. 1, Bn. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre*. Bn. 1 has a melodic line starting in measure 130, while Bn. 2 plays a sustained note.
- Horns 1 & 2 (Hn. 1, Hn. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre*. Hn. 1 plays a melodic line with triplets, and Hn. 2 plays a sustained note.
- Trumpets 1 & 2 (Tp. 1, Tp. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre* and play sixteenth-note patterns.
- Trombones 1 & 2 (Tb. 1, Tb. 2):** Both parts are marked *ff sempre* and play sustained notes.

The score is written in 4/4 time and includes various musical notations such as triplets, sixteenth notes, and sustained notes.

♩ = 84 Massive, grandiose

[illegible]

♩ = 84 Massive, grandiose

Vn. 1 tutti
ff sempre
 unis.

Vn. 2
ff sempre

Va.
ff sempre
 nondiv.

Vc.
ff sempre
 div.

D.B.
ff sempre

26

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

(8^{va})

Vn. 1
tutti

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

136

Fl. 1
Fl. 2
Ob. 1
Ob. 2
Cl. 1
Cl. 2
Bn. 1
Bn. 2

136

Hn. 1
Hn. 2
Tp. 1
Tp. 2
Tb. 1
Tb. 2

136

Perc. 1
Perc. 2
Hp.

S
A
T
B

136

(8^{va})

Vn. 1
tutti
Vn. 2
Va.
Vc.
D.B.

141

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

141

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

141

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

ter - - - - -

ter - - - - -

ter - - - - -

ter - - - - -

ni - - - - -

ni - - - - -

ni - - - - -

ni - - - - -

ty, - - - - -

ty, - - - - -

ty, - - - - -

ty, - - - - -

141

(8^{ma})

Vn. 1

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

tutti

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

6

30

146

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

f

146

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

mf

mf

mf

146

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

mf

Hp.

S

A

T

B

ni

ty,

ni

ty,

f

f

ni

ty,

146

(8^{va})

Vn. 1

tutti

f

Vn. 2

f

Va.

f

Vc.

f

D.B.

f

151

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

151

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

151

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

151

Vn. 1 tutti

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

poco a poco rit.

Fl. 1

Fl. 2 *mp*

Ob. 1

Ob. 2 *p*

Cl. 1

Cl. 2 *pp*

Bn. 1 *p*

Bn. 2

Hn. 1 *p*

Hn. 2

Tp. 1 *p*

Tp. 2 *mp* *pp*

Tb. 1

Tb. 2 *pp*

poco a poco rit.

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp. *mf* *mp*

S *mf* ty.

A *mf* ty.

T *mf* ty.

B *mf* *p* ty.

poco a poco rit.

Vn. 1 *tutti* *unis.* *p*

Vn. 2 *p*

Va. *p*

Vc. *p*

D.B. *p*

161

♩ = 63 Calm

Fl. 1 *p*

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2 *ppp*

Cl. 1

Cl. 2 *ppp*

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

161

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

161

♩ = 63 Calm

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S *pp*

A *p*

T *p*

B

Where nev - - - er moon

Where nev - - - er moon

161

♩ = 63 Calm

Vn. 1 *tutti*

Vn. 2 *pp*

Va. *pp*

Vc. *pp*

D.B. *pp*

unis.

rit.-----

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

rit.-----

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

shall sway the stars, Where nev - - - er moon

rit.-----

Vn. 1
tutti

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

shall be drown'd in end - - -

S. Vn.

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

pppp

186

191

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

186

191

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

186

191

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

186

191

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

Fl. 1

Fl. 2

Ob. 1

Ob. 2

Cl. 1

Cl. 2

Bn. 1

Bn. 2

Hn. 1

Hn. 2

Tp. 1

Tp. 2

Tb. 1

Tb. 2

Perc. 1

Perc. 2

Hp.

S

A

T

B

Vn. 1
gli altri

Vn. 2

Va.

Vc.

D.B.

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